

Thoughts, Emotions, Body Sensations & Behavior Identification Workbook

A full workbook for noticing thoughts, emotions, body signals, behaviors, triggers, and patterns.

Designed for early stages of CBT work: observation, naming, mapping, and gentle understanding.

Contents

1. Identifying an Event and First Thought

2. Automatic Thoughts Log

3. Identifying Emotions and Intensity

4. Body Sensations Map

5. Actual Response and Behavior

6. Situation-Thought-Emotion-Body-Behavior Chain

7. Repeated Patterns and Triggers

8. Initial Summary for Further Work

Reminder

These workbooks are for self-reflection, therapeutic practice, and continued work between sessions. They are not a substitute for professional care, diagnosis, or medical advice.

Form 1

Identifying an Event and First Thought

A gentle separation between what happened and the first thought that appeared.

What this form is for

To identify one clear situation and the first interpretation that followed it.

How to use it

Choose a recent event of mild or moderate intensity. Write briefly and avoid explaining everything at once.

How much is this event still occupying my mind?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

The event itself

What happened?

Where did it happen?

Who was involved?

The first thought

What was the first thought that crossed my mind?

What did I say to myself at that moment?

What meaning did I give the situation?

Facts versus interpretation

What do I know happened for sure?

What am I assuming or interpreting?

What is still unclear?

Next formulation

The main event is:

The main thought is:

The most important thing to examine next is:

Practice suggestion

Pick one event this week and write only the first thought, without debating it yet.

Reminder

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Form 2

Automatic Thoughts Log

A log for thoughts that appear quickly and feel persuasive.

What this form is for

To notice repeated automatic thoughts and the situations in which they appear.

How to use it

Fill in a few entries across a day or two. The goal is noticing, not analyzing everything.

How much do my thoughts feel like they are running the show?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Recording thoughts

A thought that came up today:

What situation brought it up?

How much did I believe it from 0 to 10?

Repeated words

Which words repeat in my thoughts?

Do words like always, never, must, or everyone appear?

Which word stands out most?

Thought content

Is the thought about me, others, the future, or danger?

What emotion follows it?

What do I usually do next?

Focus thought

Which thought is most important to examine?

What makes it feel convincing?

What question should I bring to therapy or reflection?

Practice suggestion

Once a day, catch one automatic thought and write it down without correcting it.

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Form 3

Identifying Emotions and Intensity

Distinguishing between different emotions and noticing how their intensity changes.

What this form is for

To name emotions, separate the main emotion from other feelings, and track intensity.

How to use it

Choose one situation and try to identify more than one emotion if needed.

How intense is the main emotion right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Naming the emotion

The first emotion I notice:

Another emotion that may be present:

An emotion that is hard to admit or allow:

Intensity and timing

Intensity at the beginning:

Intensity now:

When did it get stronger or softer?

What the emotion wants

What does the emotion push me to do?

Does it ask me to move away, speak, hide, rest, or protect myself?

Which part is useful?

Gentle language

How can I describe the emotion without judging it?

What would I say to someone close who felt this?

What helps the emotion become clearer?

Practice suggestion

Choose one emotion each day and name it as accurately as possible.

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Form 4

Body Sensations Map

A form for mapping physical signals that accompany thoughts and emotions.

What this form is for

To notice how the body participates in emotional responses and early warning signs.

How to use it

Focus on sensation, not diagnosis: tension, pressure, heat, heaviness, restlessness, or breathing changes.

How strongly do I notice this in my body?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Body signals

Where do I notice the sensation?

What does it feel like?

When did I first notice it?

Connection to emotion

Which emotion might be connected to this sensation?

What thought appeared near the sensation?

What action urge followed?

Early signs

What is the earliest body signal I can recognize?

What happens if I ignore it?

What helps reduce intensity slightly?

Regulation cue

A small body-based support I can try:

A supportive phrase for this sensation:

What I want to remember about my body's signals:

Practice suggestion

Once this week, pause for 30 seconds and name one body sensation without trying to change it.

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Form 5

Actual Response and Behavior

Looking at what I did, what I wanted to do, and what the response achieved.

What this form is for

To understand behavior as part of the pattern, not as a character flaw.

How to use it

Choose one situation and describe the behavior without blame.

How automatic did my response feel?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

What I did

What did I do in the situation?

What did I say or not say?

What did I avoid or seek?

What I wanted to do

What impulse came up?

What did I stop myself from doing?

What did the behavior try to protect?

Short-term result

What relief or benefit did the response give me?

What problem did it create or maintain?

How did I feel afterward?

Alternative response

What small alternative could fit next time?

What support would help?

What would count as progress, not perfection?

Practice suggestion

After one situation, write the behavior and the short-term result in two sentences.

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Form 6

Situation-Thought-Emotion-Body-Behavior Chain

A structured chain that connects the parts of a difficult moment.

What this form is for

To see how one situation develops into thoughts, feelings, body responses, and actions.

How to use it

Use one event. Fill the chain in order, without trying to solve it immediately.

How clear is the chain of my response?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Situation

What happened first?

What detail triggered the chain?

What did I notice externally?

Thought and meaning

What thought appeared?

What did it mean about me, others, or the future?

How believable did it feel?

Emotion and body

What emotion followed?

What did I feel in my body?

How intense did it become?

Behavior and consequence

What did I do next?

What happened afterward?

Where might I create a small change in the chain?

Practice suggestion

Use this chain once after a mild difficulty to learn the sequence.

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Form 7

Repeated Patterns and Triggers

Finding situations, themes, and triggers that appear again and again.

What this form is for

To move from isolated events to a clearer understanding of repeated patterns.

How to use it

Review several recent moments and look for what they have in common.

How much do I recognize repeated patterns?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Repeated situations

Which situations keep repeating?

Who or what is usually involved?

What time, place, or condition makes it more likely?

Common triggers

A trigger I notice often:

A topic that activates me:

A need or fear that may be underneath:

Repeated responses

What thought repeats?

What emotion repeats?

What behavior repeats?

Pattern summary

The pattern seems to be:

What maintains it?

A small place to interrupt it:

Practice suggestion

At the end of the week, look for one repeated trigger and name it clearly.

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Form 8

Initial Summary for Further Work

A first summary of observations to guide therapy or self-work.

What this form is for

To collect what has been noticed and decide what needs further exploration.

How to use it

Use after completing several forms or before a therapy session.

How ready am I to choose a focus for further work?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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What I noticed

A thought pattern I noticed:

An emotion that repeats:

A body signal or behavior that repeats:

What seems important

What feels most important to understand?

What still feels confusing?

What should not be ignored?

Working hypothesis

One possible explanation for the pattern:

One factor that may maintain it:

One strength that may help:

Next focus

The topic I want to work on next:

A question to bring to therapy:

A small experiment or observation for the week:

Practice suggestion

Choose one observation from this summary and use it as your focus for the next week.

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